Master Software Development Agreement

Between: Northwind Digital Ltd. ("Client-facing Studio") and **Acme Corp** ("Client")

Effective Date: October 1, 2026

Currency: All amounts in this Agreement are stated and payable in **United States Dollars (USD)**.

1. Engagement

Acme Corp engages the Studio to design, build, and deliver the Phase 1 backend architecture for the Acme Commerce Platform, on a fixed-milestone basis.

2. Payment Mechanics

All milestone payments shall be made to the Studio via **PayPal** to the business account nominated by the Studio. The Client's authorised PayPal payer address for this Agreement is **sb-buyer@personal.example.com**.

3. Milestones and Fees

Section 3.1: Client shall pay **$1,000.00 USD** upon Phase 1 delivery on or before **October 15, 2026** (Milestone Code **MS-01** — "Phase 1: Backend Architecture Delivery").

4. Late Payment and Penalties

Section 4.2: Any payment received below the milestone amount or more than **3 days** past the due date incurs a mandatory **5.00%** administrative late fee on the full milestone balance. The grace period for MS-01 is **three (3) calendar days** following the due date.

5. Partial Payments

Section 5.4: Partial payment of any milestone is **FORBIDDEN**. A transfer received for less than the full milestone amount is treated as an underpayment and

the outstanding balance becomes immediately due.

6. Currency

Payments made in any currency other than USD shall be flagged as a currency mismatch and are not deemed compliant until the full USD equivalent is received.

7. Governing Law

This Agreement is governed by the laws of England and Wales.